

SHANGHAI STUDIO DEV TOURNAMENT 2026



CONTEXT



STUDIO AMBITION

Leading global projects from
concept to execution



NETWORK ALIGNMENT

Turning local game ideas
into studio-backed reality



CHINESE MARKET

Rooted in China, built for
the world

**SELECTING & SPONSORING
STUDIO'S BEST CONCEPTS
TO WIN HQ GREEN LIGHT.**



WHY PARTICIPATE

PURE PITCH

FOCUS ON GREAT
CONCEPTS AND
IDEAS, NOT DEMOS.

FOCUSED CHALLENGES

CLEAR FRAMEWORK
TO FOCUS YOUR
CREATIVITY.

STUDIO BACKING

EARN STUDIO
SPONSORSHIP AND
BACKING.





WHAT WE ARE EXPECTING

Deliverables

Pitch with a strong focus on gameplay toy

Theme/Setting:

Recognizably iconic Chinese elements;
World & immersive maps for players to explore.

Scope/Ambition:

Premium, Mid size project (< 20 hours playtime,
such as AC Mirage, Subnautica)

Market: China first and globally appealing

Genre: Action; Action-Adventure; Action RPG



MEET THE JUDGE PANEL

EVALUATE GAME PITCHES AND PROTOTYPES BASED ON PREDEFINED CRITERIA TO DETERMINE WINNERS AND PROVIDE CONSTRUCTIVE FEEDBACK.



CAI XIA
PRODUCER



DAVID MAURIN
SENIOR LEAD GAME DESIGNER



HU YI DONG
SENIOR GAME & MARKET ANALYST



IVAN MARGUIN
LEAD QUEST DESIGNER



JEAN-FÉLIX MONIN
CREATIVE DIRECTOR



LE MIN
PRODUCTION DIRECTOR (CO-DEV)



WILFRIED HARY
GENERAL MANAGER MARKETING,
CHINA



EVALUATION CRITERIA

1 CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY

Creativity: Does the proposed game contain unique ideas, or combine existing ideas in a novel way?

Disruptivity: Does the game innovate in unexpected ways? Either through a technical breakthrough, a new monetization system, a new control scheme, or something else?

Consistency: Do the parts all fit together in a consistent whole with a clear creative intention?

2 GAMEPLAY & MECHANICS

Core gameplay loop: Does your game have a well-defined, deep loop with strong expandability?

Depth vs. complexity: Does your game strike an ideal balance between ease of entry and deep, strategic gameplay?

Unique features and innovations: Does your game include strongly innovative, well-integrated, and highly marketable differentiators?

Game objectives and feedback loop: Does your game have layered objectives with diverse and timely feedback, strongly motivating players?

Player progress and pacing: Does your game have seamless pacing, consistently introducing new elements to maintain player curiosity?

Player experience and emotional engagement: Is your game a highly engaging, emotionally driven experience with strong replay value?



TIMELINE OVERVIEW

Phase 1: Kickoff & Registration	Phase 2: Pitch Development & Evaluation
A final list of pitch	Pitch presentation evaluated & finalist teams chosen.
2 weeks (Aug 17 th – Aug 28 th)	3 weeks (Aug 31 st – Sep 18 th)



PHASE 1: KICK-OFF & REGISTRATION

MILESTONE	ACTION	DEADLINE
Launch & Live streaming	• Official Announcement: Email launch accompanied by a live-streamed info session. • Live Stream Info Session (Aug 20): A panel of judges will walk through key tournament details, framework, expectations, and evaluation criteria, etc.	Aug 17 th
Pitcher Registration	• Registration Window: Open from Aug 17 – Aug 28. • Team Matchmaking & Solo Pitching: Pitch ideas are posted to [Confluence Page] for pitchers looking to recruit collaborators. • Proceed as a Team: Fly with whatever number of collaborators you've recruited. • Go Solo: Pitch individually—solo submissions are fully supported! • Withdraw: Opt out before registration closes if a team was required for your concept.	Aug 28 th



PHASE 2 : PITCH DEVELOPMENT & EVALUATION

MILESTONE	ACTION	DEADLINE
Pitch development	• Pitch Guide: Access official pitch templates via the [Confluence Page]. • Mentorship & Feedback: Reach out to senior colleagues in the studio for feedback.	Pitch Submission: Sep 14 th
Pitch Evaluation	• Presentation Format: 20-min live pitch + 10-min Q&A per team (order determined by random draw). • Feedback Loop: All teams will receive written judge feedback via email within 1 week.	Sep 14 th –18 th
Closing Ceremony & Awards	Celebration & Winners Announcement: Event details, venue, and final agenda coming soon.	TBD



IMPORTANT DAYS

